Unit 4 · Present continuous (+ and –)

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

We use the present continuous for what is happening right now, while we speak.

Present continuous — это то, что происходит прямо сейчас, пока мы говорим.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
+	subject · am / is / are · verb-ing	**I'm swimming. He's sailing.**	Я плаваю (сейчас). Он плывёт на яхте.
No	subject · am / is / are · not · verb-ing	**They aren't surfing.**	Они не занимаются сёрфингом.
Spelling 1	most verbs: + ing	**play → playing**	
Spelling 2	ends in e: drop the e, + ing	**dive → diving**	
Spelling 3	one short vowel + one consonant: double it	**swim → swimming · run → running**	

When we use it

What is happening now? Look! She's reading.
Что происходит сейчас.

Today or at the moment: I'm learning English.
Сегодня или в этот момент.

Describe a picture: The boy is kayaking.
Описать картинку.

REMEMBER

Now! Look! Right now · at the moment · today. It is happening while we speak.

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

Russian uses ONE form for 'always' and 'now': «Я плаваю». English has TWO: I swim (usually) and I'M SWIMMING (now). Ask: «Сейчас или всегда?»

Watch out! We often say...

~~I swimming.~~	**I'm swimming.**
~~He is swim.~~	**He is swimming.**
~~They no surfing.~~	**They aren't surfing.**

EASY TRICK

TWO parts: BE + ING. Forget one and it breaks: «I swimming» (no be) · «I am swim» (no -ing).

Try it! Circle the right answer

1 Look! The boy ___. (is surfing / surfs)

2 I ___ now. (am dancing / dance)

3 They ___ a kayak. (aren't use / aren't using)

4 swim → ___

5 dive → ___

6 She ___ right now. (is not run / isn't running)

Answers: 1 is surfing · 2 am dancing · 3 aren't using · 4 swimming · 5 diving · 6 isn't running